Graphic Design

Adobe Photoshop

Movie Poster

Summary Notes

Contents

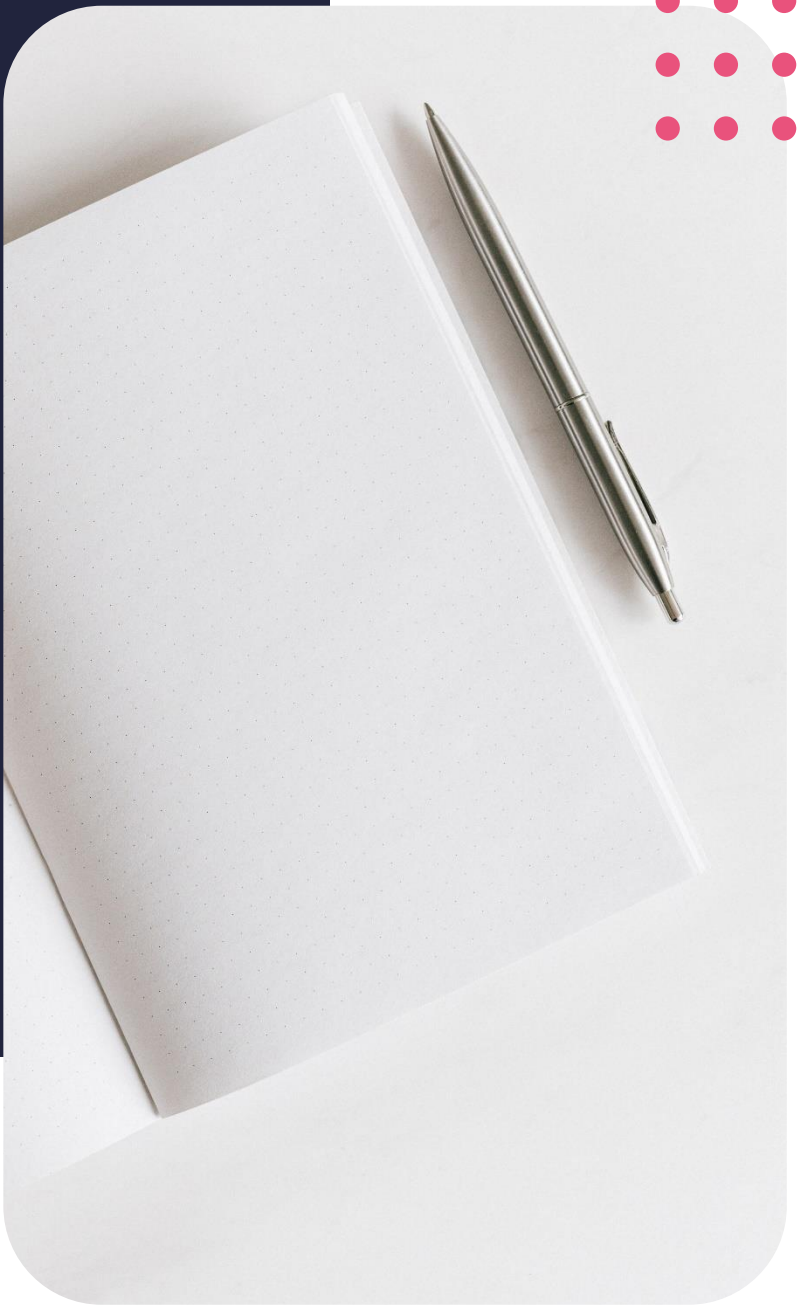
3 Introduction

The Golden Ratio

5 Rule of Thirds

6 Dieter Ram's ten principles of good design

7 Photoshop demo



Introduction

For this lesson, I would like to quote German industrial designer, Dieter Rams. “Good design is thorough down to the last detail – nothing must be arbitrary or left to chance. Care and accuracy in the design process show respect towards the consumer.”

The Golden Ratio

Our lesson today will focus on the interface of Photoshop but before we get there, I would like to introduce some Our lesson today entails the golden ratio as well as the principles of good design by famous industrial designer, Dieter Rams. We will then move over to learn some more awesome tricks in PS and design a movie poster!

I’m sure you are familiar with the golden ratio, golden section, golden mean or divine proportion. In short, it is an irrational mathematical equation of 1.61803398875...that never ends. This is known as Phi.

What has math to do with graphic design though? Well, if you take a rectangle created with the golden ratio in mind and cut a square off it, you create a smaller rectangle with the same golden ratio proportions that never ends.

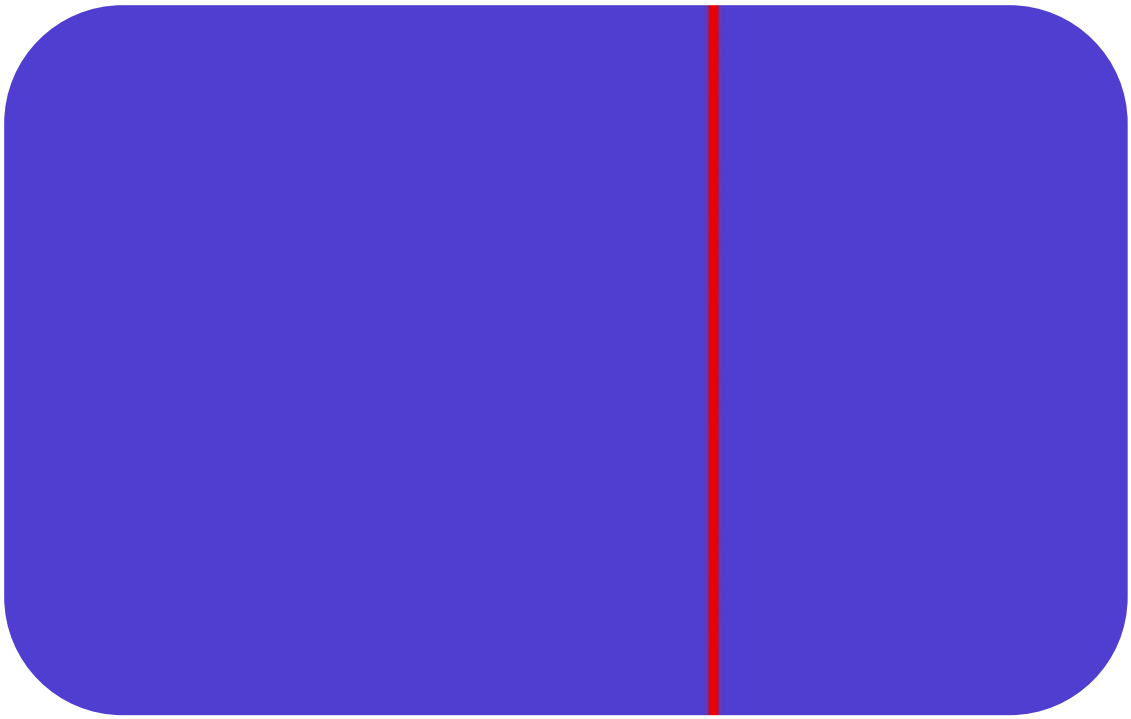


Image 1: A rectangle created with the golden ratio proportions.

This links to the Fibonacci sequence. Which is where each following number is the sum of the two numbers before it.

1,1,2,3,5,8,13,21…

1+1=2
1+2=3
2+3=5
3+5=8

If you connect each corner of your squares in an arch form, you will eventually get the golden spiral and this golden spiral is visible in nature almost everywhere – even in nature! Looking at this image of the shell, you can see that the focus of the shell in front is placed in the centre of the spiral. Also note that the shell itself also forms a golden ratio spiral!

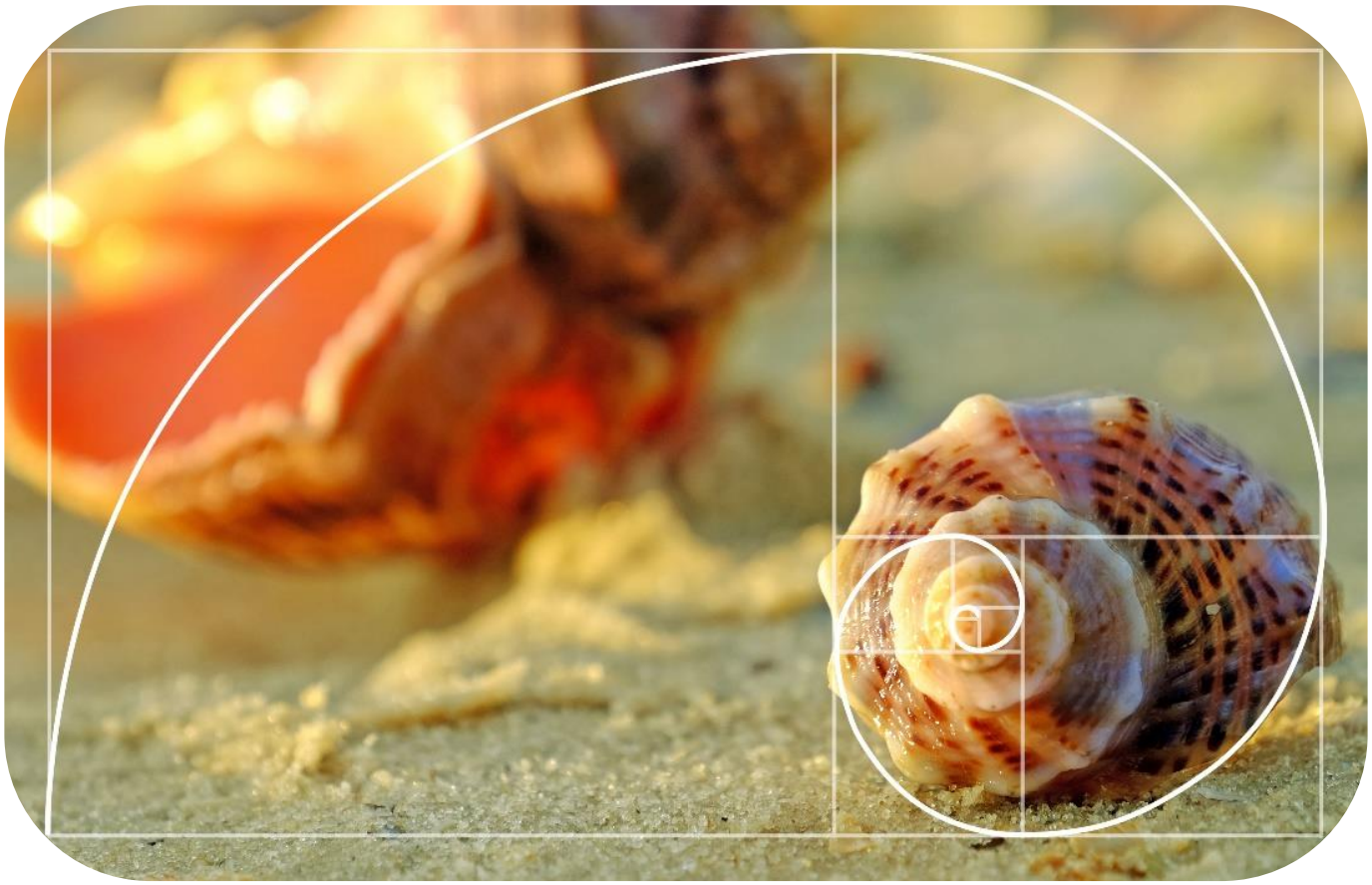


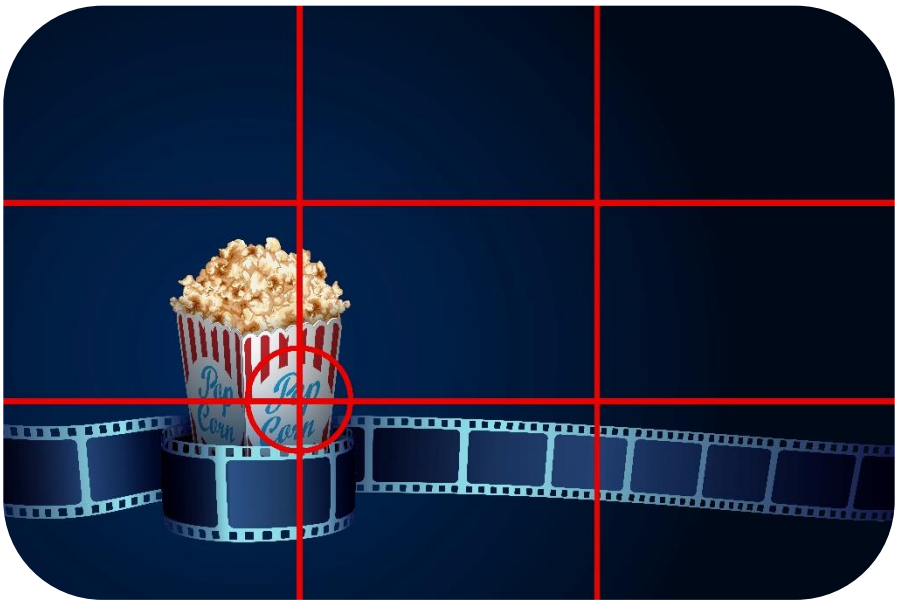
Image 2: Photograph and shell with the golden ratio proportion to create harmony

Isn't nature amazing? The reason why this is so significant is based on the reason that it can create unintentional aesthetically pleasing designs that have been applied in various forms of design successfully throughout the years.

Rule of Thirds

If the golden ratio still confuses you, then simply learn to apply the rule of thirds to your artwork. The rule of thirds can create a storyline by simply showing more on the side of your focus instead of having your focus in the centre.

The rule of thirds is simple in that you simply divide your artwork into three equal vertical and horizontal blocks.



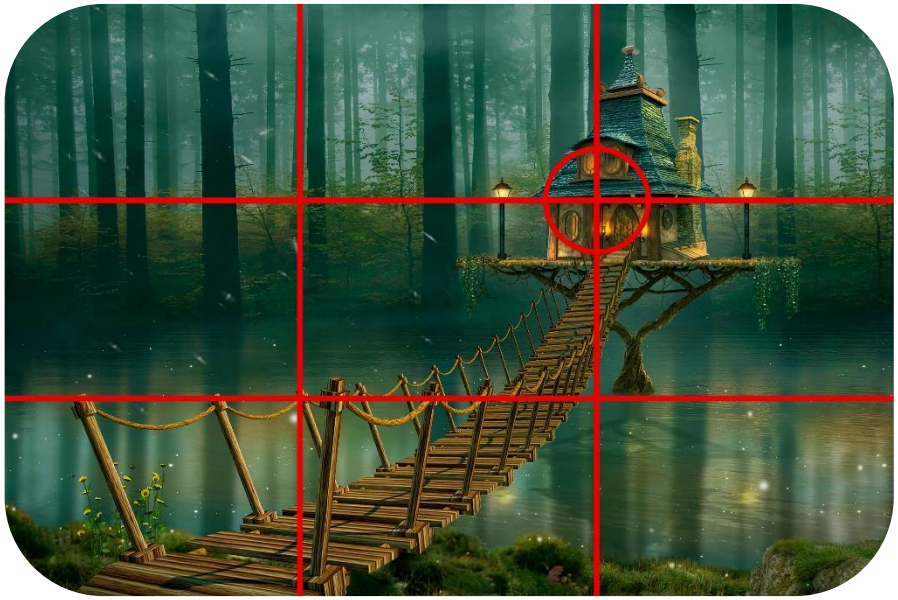


Image 3 & 4: The rule of thirds at play

Where one vertical and horizontal line intersect is where you will add your focus point. In this case, the box of popcorn in image 3 is added to the bottom left intersection.

It helps to create asymmetrical balance within a design that is more pleasing and dynamic to the viewer - exactly like the golden ratio does.

Dieter Ram's 10 principles of good design

Moving on to Dieter Rams' 10 principles of good design, I would like you to try and apply these principles to your artwork from now on.

Dieter Ram's principles of good design consist of 10 concepts:

1. Is innovative
2. Makes a product useful
3. Is aesthetic
4. Makes a product understandable
5. Is unobtrusive
6. Is honest
7. Is long-lasting
8. Is thorough down to the last detail
9. Is environmentally friendly
10. Involves as little design as possible

Looking at the Volkswagen advert, how many of these principles do you think have been applied? Or rather, which of these do you think have not been applied?

Image 5: Volkswagen advert with Ram's principles of good design at play.

Of course, Rams' principles of good design not only relate to graphic design but all forms of design including architecture, industrial design, interior design, fashion, photography and so on.

Try and apply these principles to all future design projects you might be a part of.

Photoshop Demo

In Photoshop I will teach you a couple of new tricks, specifically working with layer masks and the reason why masks are so important.

You can choose any of the following themes to create your movie poster: Horror, sci-fi, fantasy or action. Please be original and rather create your own movie than taking an existing movie. Let the creative juices flow!

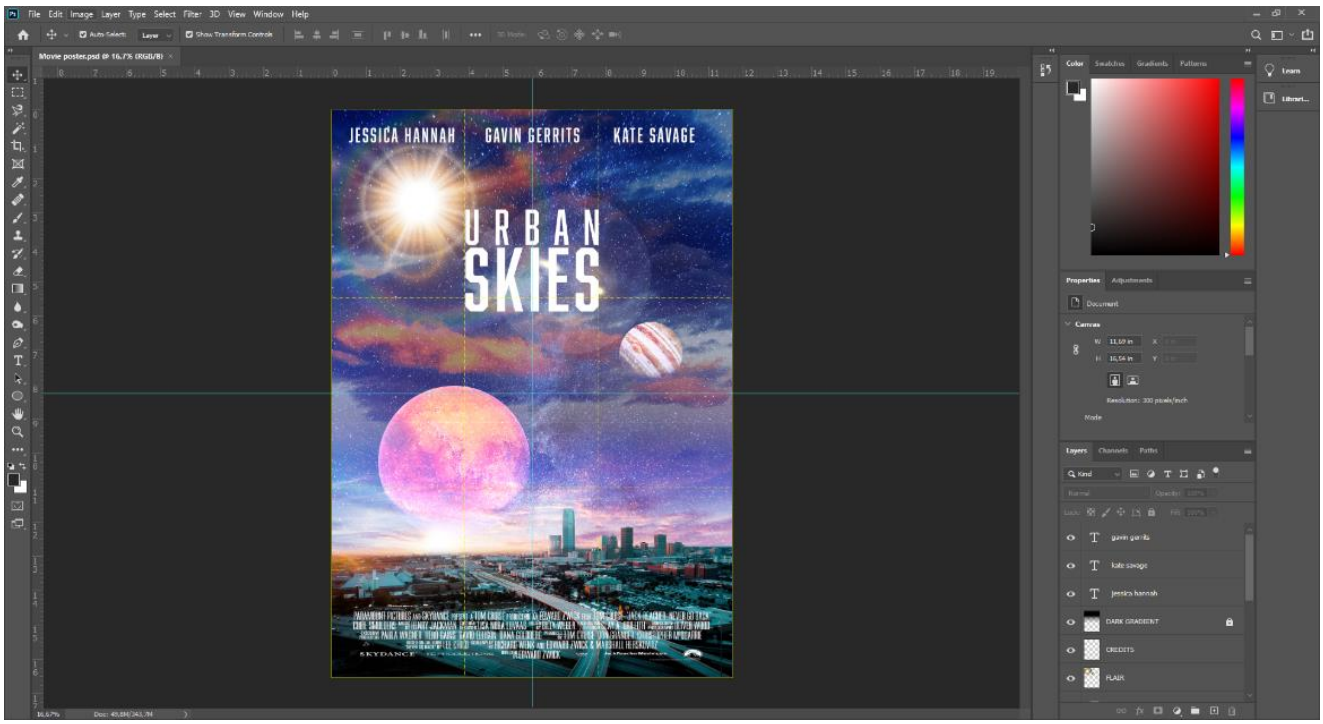


Image 6: Demo screenshot on lesson 6

We will specifically look at creating layer masks, working and understanding layer masks as well as photomanipulation. Please refer to the video of lesson 6 for more in-depth insight on this tutorial.

By simply utilising the skills you have learnt in Photoshop so far, you will be able to get a similar result as this. I am so excited to see what you created and I'm sure your fellow classmates as well, so please share your movie poster using #shawmovieposter

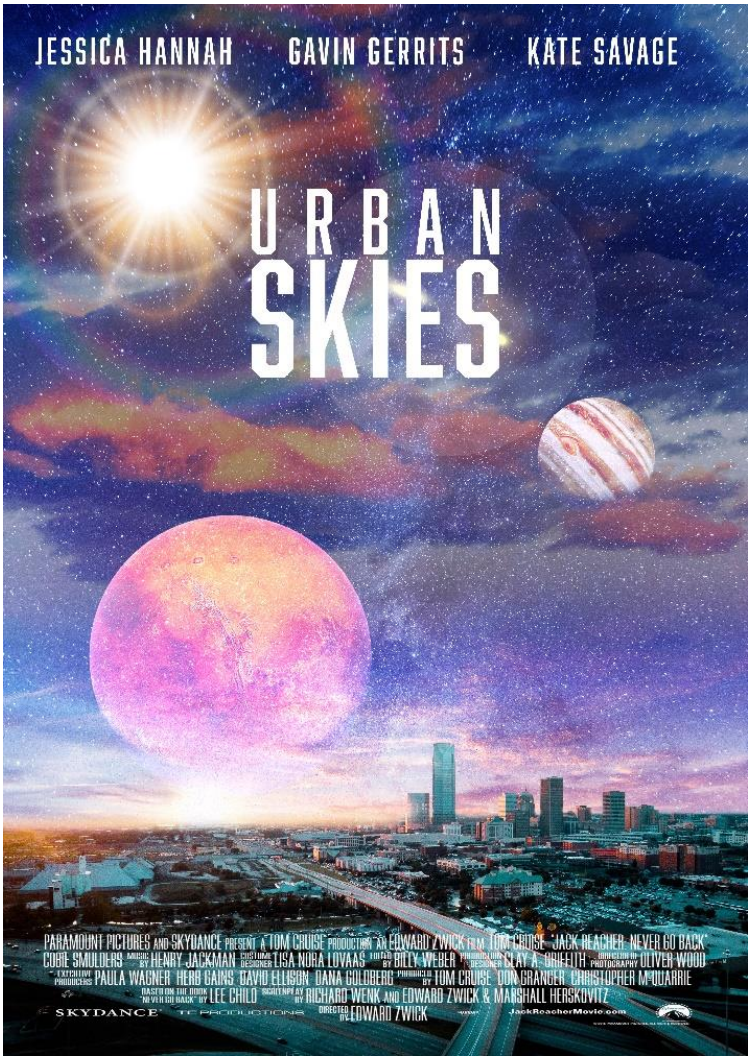


Image 7: Final movie poster creation using Adobe Photoshop

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We have reached the end of lesson 6 and for next week, I would like you to get all excited as we explore InDesign. With only two lessons to go, I hope you are even more excited to see what we will get up to in Adobe InDesign next week!